

August 13, 2026

Cigna Healthcare  
Cigna Appeals Unit  
P.O. Box 188011  
Chattanooga, TN 37422

**RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Mohamed Hermann (MRN MUSC6525710), Claim MUSC-BC1F-1**

|                          |                                                                                           |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Patient</b>           | Mohamed Hermann (DOB 1996-10-29)                                                          |
| <b>MRN</b>               | MUSC6525710                                                                               |
| <b>Member ID / Group</b> | CIG627241918 / GRP-90544                                                                  |
| <b>Claim number</b>      | MUSC-BC1F-1                                                                               |
| <b>Date of service</b>   | 2026-01-05                                                                                |
| <b>Procedure billed</b>  | CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity             |
| <b>Primary diagnosis</b> | J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified                                    |
| <b>Denied amount</b>     | \$694.01                                                                                  |
| <b>Denial code</b>       | CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s). |
| <b>Appeal deadline</b>   | 2026-08-11                                                                                |

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

**SUMMARY OF APPEAL**

MUSC Health is submitting this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient Mohamed Hermann (MRN: MUSC6165460, Member ID: CIG627241918, Group: GRP-90544) regarding the denial of Claim ID MUSC-BC1F-1, with a date of service of January 5, 2026, submitted on January 13, 2026. The claim was denied on February 12, 2026, under CARC 16 and RARC N290, with the payer remark stating: "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid," specifically citing a missing, incomplete, or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and submits that the rendering provider's National Provider Identifier (NPI) was valid and present on the original claim submission.

**CLINICAL BACKGROUND**

Mr. Hermann, a 29-year-old established male patient, was seen on January 5, 2026, at MUSC Health University Medical Center in Charleston, SC, an on-campus outpatient hospital facility (Place of Service 22). The visit was rendered by Dr. Priya N. Raghavan, MD, and was billed under CPT code 99214, representing an office or outpatient visit for an established patient of moderate complexity, with a primary diagnosis of J06.9 (Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified) and a secondary diagnosis of R69. The claim was submitted with Revenue Code 0510 and reflects a billed amount of \$694.01, against which Cigna's allowed amount was calculated at \$490.24, with no payment issued.

## **BASIS FOR APPEAL**

The sole stated basis for denial is RARC N290, indicating that the rendering provider's primary identifier was missing, incomplete, or invalid. MUSC Health asserts that this characterization is inaccurate. Dr. Priya N. Raghavan, MD, holds an active and valid NPI of 1669504132, which was included on the claim as submitted on January 13, 2026. This NPI is registered in the National Plan and Provider Enumeration System (NPPES) and is the appropriate primary identifier for a rendering provider under HIPAA standard transaction requirements. If a data formatting or transmission issue caused the identifier to appear absent or unreadable during Cigna's adjudication process, that constitutes a technical processing error rather than a substantive deficiency in the claim. The underlying service was rendered by a credentialed, identifiable provider to a covered member during an active coverage period, and the claim contains all elements necessary for adjudication. Denial of payment on this basis, without providing an opportunity to correct a clerical or technical discrepancy, is inconsistent with standard claims processing obligations and applicable appeal rights under the plan.

## **REQUESTED ACTION**

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Cigna Healthcare reopen and reprocess Claim ID MUSC-BC1F-1 using the valid NPI on file for Dr. Priya N. Raghavan, MD (NPI 1669504132), and issue payment at the applicable contracted rate for CPT 99214 as rendered on January 5, 2026. Supporting documentation, including the medical record for the date of service and provider credentialing information confirming the active NPI, is enclosed with this appeal submission. Should Cigna require any additional information to complete adjudication, MUSC Health requests prompt written notification so that any outstanding items may be addressed without further delay. This appeal is being submitted within the applicable appeal deadline of August 11, 2026, through the designated portal in accordance with Cigna's appeal submission requirements.

Respectfully submitted,

**Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC**

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## **Enclosures**

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record